10. Westerlies are normally stronger in areas where there is no land as land amplifies flow pattern by making the wind current to move more north south. It plays an important role in bringing warm, equatorial waters and winds to western coasts particularly in southern hemisphere due to its huge oceanic stretch. It is strongest in Southern Hemisphere because of the absence of varied heating rates which results because of no land masses, so only statement 1 is correct which makes option (a) correct.
11. It is seen that Malacca Strait appears as mainly and singly navigation channel which covers more than one third of cargo movement, hence by deepening its channel will lower the repair and waiting period of heavy liners, hence statement 1 is correct. By opening new canal in Kra Insthums will also lower the navigation time and distance, hence statement 2 is also correct.
12. It is known that the lower deltaic plains of Ganges and Brahmaputra are characterised by swamps and sundarbans where people can easily grow Paddy and Jute crops as both these crops are water intensive and both needs the temperature above 25°C, so with this explanation option (c) is correct.
13. African and Eurasian desert belt lies in vicinity of cold currents having desiccating effect on air, so with this we see that statement 2 is incorrect. Normally it is seen that deserts are mostly located around 20-30° north and south of Equator along Tropics of Cancer and Capricorn. The hot air at equator rises and spreads north and south before cooling which further gets condense and tends to release moisture over tropical zones creating equatorial zone of low atmospheric pressure. Two tropical zones are at high pressure close to the poles which are two low cooler pressure belts. When denser air sinks to two subtropical high pressure belts, it creates a wind which is hot without moisture that normally appears from Sahara, hence statement 1 is correct, so the best option is (a).
14. From the surface of the earth upto altitude of 10-20 km, temperature decreases with increase in altitude which is known as troposphere. This happens because the Sun rays will able to penetrate from the atmosphere rather than heating the surface from below. Now above this belt is stratosphere, where